

Cursor Training Guide

A short guide to running daily reports and IFP forecasts with Cursor chat.

Start Here

Cursor is a chat assistant built into a code editor. You type what you need in plain English — it runs scripts, calls IFP, and edits files for you.

Three things you can do today:

1. Run the **daily publishers report**
2. Run an **IFP forecast**
3. **Ask questions** or change settings

Before you start: [Connect to Hulu VPN](#) (required for IFP).

Think of Cursor as VS Code with a helper that can take action — not just answer questions.

Manual step	Ask Cursor instead
Fill out the IFP portal	"Run a forecast for 7/10 Hulu US, Baton Rouge, 2 per hour"
Run a script and debug errors	"Run @dailyPublishersscript.py"
Edit config files by hand	"Add Disney Plus to the targeting"

Note: Cursor uses the IFP **API**, not the IFP portal website.

Part 2: Getting Started

Step 1 — Open a project

In Cursor: **File** → **Open Folder**, then choose:

- `all-publishers-daily-report` — for the daily report
- `ifp-frequency-cap-tests` — for IFP forecasts

Step 2 — Open chat

Press **Ctrl+I** and select **Agent mode**.

Step 3 — Type your request

No special syntax needed. Describe what you want in normal language. Use **@** to attach a file.

Part 3: The Three Workflows

Workflow 1: Daily Publishers Report

In chat:

```
Run @dailypublisherscript.py
```

What it does: Pulls today's MSTR files from Outlook, updates the Excel template, refreshes pivots, and opens an email draft for you to review and send.

To run yourself:

```
cd C:\Users\syeda012\projects\all-publishers-daily-report
py dailypublisherscript.py
```

Tip: On Windows, use `py` not `python` if you see "Python was not found."

Workflow 2: IFP Forecasts

Quick forecast (one question):

Describe the forecast you need:

```
Run a forecast for 7/10 Hulu US, Baton Rouge DMA, 2 per hour
```

Cursor returns **capacity**, **available**, and the **ratio**.

Multiple frequency caps (batch test):

In chat:

```
Run the frequency cap test matrix  
Show available and capacity for all scenarios
```

Or in PowerShell:

```
cd C:\Users\syeda012\projects\ifp-frequency-cap-tests  
.\scripts\run-forecasts.ps1
```

Results are saved to output\results.json. Ask Cursor to summarize them if you don't want to read the file yourself.

Cap units: MINUTE, HOUR, or DAY only. For a monthly cap, use **4 per 30 DAY**.

Workflow 3: Ask for Help or Changes

You don't need to know which file to edit. Examples:

Task	What to type
Change targeting	"Add Disney Plus to publisher targeting"
Look up a DMA	"What's the DMA code for Baton Rouge?"
Understand a script	"Explain how dailypublisherscript.py works"
Fix an error	"Why did the last command fail?"

DMA names vs codes: The IFP portal shows names (e.g. Baton Rouge). The API uses numbers (e.g. 716). Ask Cursor to look it up, or check `reference/dma-codes.json`.

Files you might edit manually:

Setting	File
Dates, targeting	<code>config/base-request.json</code>
Frequency cap tests	<code>reference/cap-ratio-expectations.json</code>
DMA lookup	<code>reference/dma-codes.json</code>

Part 4: Good to Know

Agent vs Ask mode

Mode	When to use
Agent	You want Cursor to run or change something
Ask	You only want an explanation

@ mentions — type `@` plus a filename to point Cursor at the right file:

```
Run @dailypublisherscript.py
```

MCP — if configured, Cursor can call IFP directly from chat. You don't need to set this up; just ask for a forecast when VPN is on.

Part 5: Common Problems

Problem	What to do
Python was not found	Use <code>py</code> instead of <code>python</code>
Connection error	Connect to Hulu VPN
DMA name vs number	Ask Cursor or check <code>reference/dma-codes.json</code>

Problem	What to do
PowerShell script blocked	Run: <code>Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope CurrentUser RemoteSigned</code>

Part 6: Copy-Paste Prompts

Run @dailypublisherscript.py

Run a forecast for [date] Hulu US, [city] DMA, [N] per [hour/day]

Run the frequency cap test matrix

What's the DMA code for [city name]?

Walk me through how to run a frequency cap test

Shortcuts

Action	Key
Open chat	<code>Ctrl+I</code>
Open terminal	<code>Ctrl+`</code>

Security

- Do not paste passwords or tokens into chat.
- Do not share forecast data outside the team.
- Review changes before accepting them.

Internal use — RYM / Inventory